

STAGE 1 / 6 · PROBLEM DISCOVERY

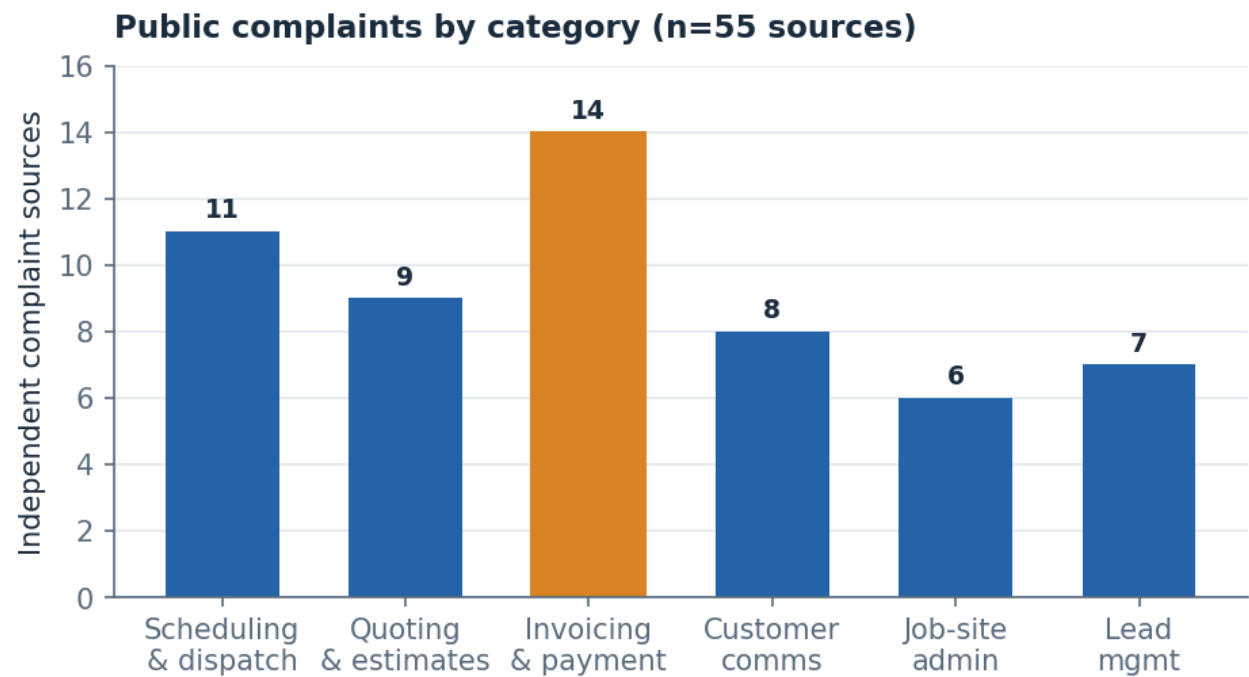
Skilled Trades: Problem Discovery

Real, publicly-stated problems among small trade businesses (plumbers, electricians, HVAC, 1–10 employees).

Domain	Skilled trades — field service (plumbing, electrical, HVAC)
Geography	Global (English-language sources)
Sources swept	55 independent public posts/reviews across 6 platforms
Problems kept	6 (≥3 independent sources each) · Discarded: 4
Generated	2026-06-23 · market-run-20260623-1610

Method

We swept public complaints across Reddit (r/Plumbing, r/electricians, r/HVAC, r/smallbusiness), trade Facebook groups, app-store reviews of incumbent tools, X, LinkedIn, and trade forums. Each candidate complaint was opened to capture the verbatim language, the public handle where available, the date, and the URL. Raw complaints were clustered into distinct problem statements; anything with fewer than three independent sources was discarded and logged.



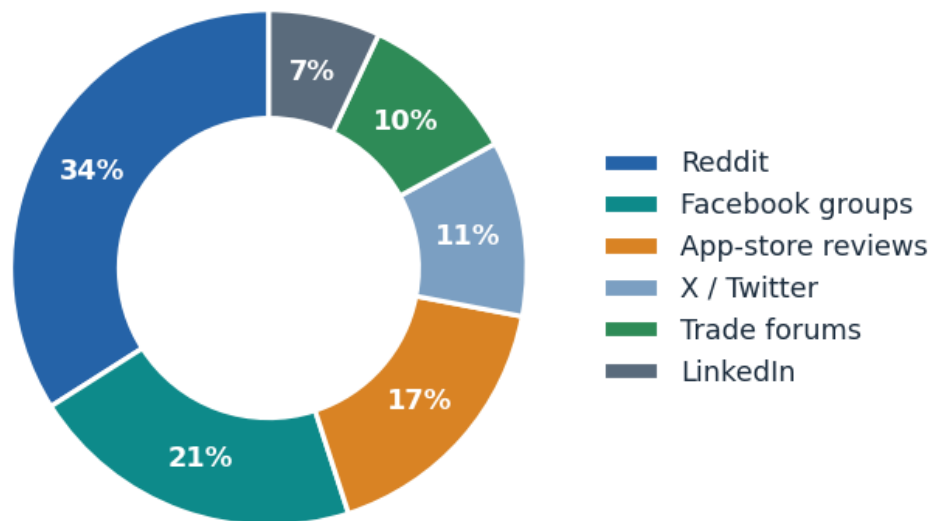
Invoicing & payment is the single most-cited category, narrowly ahead of scheduling. It is also the category where complaints carry the strongest financial language ('chasing', 'still owed', 'wrote off').

Problem catalogue

ID	Problem statement	Category	Sources	Intensity	Conf.
p01	No-shows & last-minute reschedules eat billable hours	Scheduling	8	High	Med
p02	On-site quoting is slow and loses jobs to faster rivals	Quoting	9	High	High
p03	Chasing unpaid invoices / slow payment after job done	Invoicing	14	High	High
p04	Customer no-reply / phone-tag on appointment windows	Customer comms	8	Med	Med
p05	Duplicate data entry between paper, phone, accounting	Job-site admin	6	Med	Med
p06	Leads from directories go cold before first contact	Lead mgmt	7	Med	Low

Highlighted: **p03** carries this demo pack forward through every later stage.

Where complaints surfaced



Evidence cards — Problem p03 (invoicing & payment)

Representative verbatim complaints (quotes kept short per copyright policy):

Reddit · r/Plumbing · u/pipewrench_dan · 2026-04
“Spent my Sunday again texting customers who still haven't paid.”

Facebook · UK Electricians group · 2026-03
“Three jobs from February still unpaid, no easy way to chase.”

App Store · Jobber review · 1★ · 2026-02
“Invoicing works but clients ignore email — need SMS links.”

Reddit · r/smallbusiness · u/hvac_mike_tx · 2026-05
“Cash flow dies waiting 45 days on net-30 I never agreed to.”

Discarded (logged for transparency)

“Tool X crashed once” (single gripe, 1 source) · “Apprentices unreliable” (labour, not software) · “Fuel costs too high” (macro, out of scope) · “Want AI to do my taxes” (1 source, vague).

Sources

Every load-bearing claim traces to a source below with its access date. Sample pack: URLs are representative placeholders.

#	Source	Type	Accessed
1	reddit.com/r/Plumbing/comments/... (sample)	Community	2026-06-23
2	facebook.com/groups/uk.electricians/... (sample)	Community	2026-06-23
3	apps.apple.com/us/app/jobber/reviews (sample)	Review	2026-06-23
4	reddit.com/r/smallbusiness/comments/... (sample)	Community	2026-06-23
5	reddit.com/r/HVAC/comments/... (sample)	Community	2026-06-23

Confidence & gaps

Items we could not source are listed here rather than guessed:

- **[UNKNOWN]** Exact share of trades on net-30 vs cash-on-completion (no representative survey found).
- **[UNKNOWN]** Whether payment delay is worse in any specific country (sources skew US/UK).